COVER STORY



Raghunath Subramanian,
President and CEO (India & APAC)

UiPath

DELIVERING VALUE BY AUTOMATING ROUTINE, UNPRODUCTIVE TASKS

By Shaheen Saikia

Benjamin Franklin once said, "Time is money". Living in the fast-paced 21st century, this phrase is now more relevant than ever. For the business landscape which is characterized by cut-throat competition and relentless drive to distinguish oneself in the market, time is probably everything. Yet, most of the businesses are wasting a significant amount of their precious time, day to day, on mundane, repetitive and time-consuming tasks that require little to no creativity at all. These unproductive business processes take their toll on the overall productivity of an organization and the satisfaction level of the employees. This is where Robotic Process Automation (RPA), one of the most exciting technologies of the modern era, emerges as a lifesaver. Bringing in the potential to save anywhere from 50 percent to 80 percent in process costs, RPA is being applauded for its ability to eradicate unproductive activities from the job description of the employees and providing businesses with new found space and energy to focus on business-critical tasks. No wonder, the technology is expected to touch 2.9 Billion USD mark by 2021, as per a Forrester report.

Realizing the immense potential of this revolutionary technology, enterprises are keen to leverage it to overhaul their business processes and are looking for an adept RPA solution provider who can take them through this transformation. While there

Multifold Approach to Security

When it comes to security, UiPath has taken a multifold approach to ensure that it is flawless, unmatched and enterprise grade. Latest industry standard TSL 1.2 and 256-bit encryption ensures that enhanced network and credential security is in place. Role-based access controls protect the system from unauthorized access. While connecting the UiPath Robot to Orchestrator, users are required to provide the Windows login details. Users are also given the option to store and manage their credentials and password in third-party applications such as CyberArk Enterprise Password Vault and CyberArk Application Identity Manager. IP set standards further strengthen the authentication processes.

VAPT tests are mandated before customers onboard the platform. UiPath is also a Veracode certified product. On the developer's end, machine control such as Microsoft Team Foundation Server acts as a shield. Furthermore, for every transaction made by the robot, the log files capture and keep a track of every action. Users have the freedom to add as many field as possible to get as much data. In a recent instance, UiPath's RPA platform proved its strength against the most sophisticated manual and automated tests at NASA and was commended as one of the most secured RPA platform in the industry.

are many players struggling to make a mark in the RPA segment, New York headquartered UiPath has already carved out a niche for itself in the market with their state-of-the-art enterprise RPA platform-UiPath. Driven by the idea that 'work should be inspiring for everyone', UiPath confesses to the mission of paving the road to a new way of working. UiPath has been recognized by leading groups such as Everest as an RPA Industry Leader and 'Star Performer' for two consecutive years and by Forrester as an Industry Leader for its outstanding technology. Between the years 2016 and 2017, the company grew from a little over 80 enterprise customers to over 700 enterprise customers, recording a staggering 1000 percent growth, and now is serving more than 1,100 customers. Speaking of the numerous benefits that UiPath offers to organizations, Raghunath Subramanian, President and CEO (India & APAC), UiPath shares, "Every organization has various core and support processes. Think of anything from supply chain, finance to HR processes and more, and you'll see that RPA has a direct applicability. With our RPA platform, we have been focusing on ensuring all manual, repetitive activities in organizations are automated. Besides, enterprises today have a number of different applications for different processes. Working in such heterogeneous application environment, continuously switching between multiple systems can be a humongous task for employees. The UiPath RPA platform interacts with all these applications in real time. As a result, processing happens at a much faster rate and accurately with no scope for error."

A Robust Architecture

The UiPath Enterprise RPA platform is a robust platform that is quick in its implementation and approximately 40 percent -50 percent faster than the ones of its peers. The system essentially comprises of three integrated components- UiPath Studio, UiPath Orchestrator, and UiPath Robot. UiPath Studio is the hub where workflows are developed and digitised and business processes are automated. Characterised by an extensible architecture, UiPath Studio enables developers to build anything on top of it in a bi-directional manner. They do not need a machine learning algorithm specialist to codify data for them. The component renders a developer with APIs that can be used to build programs that solve complex business problems. Built with multiple recording features, it also can create visual posts, and record all actions in real time in the form of desktop, web and Citrix recordings.

Created out of UiPath Studio are the UiPath Robots. One can choose between Attended Robots which collaborate and work with their human counterparts in the workflow or Unattended Robots which works autonomously. A key force behind automating several back-office activities like invoice processing, customer onboarding and more, these Unattended Robots will make your life easier. Advanced cognitive capabilities and OCR technology only make these Robots all the more lucrative. Google OCR is the default technology; however, users can also switch to Microsoft or the industry de facto standard ABBYY. Just like driverless cars, UiPath Robots also use computer vision to identify features by viewing screen changes and inferring the location of data points as well as which points are affected during the change. As a very simple use case, an intermediary service layer renders everything through Citrix in audio-visual format for customized interactions. At the same time, UiPath comes with its own set of core machine learning algorithms which are fully integrated into the system and enables the robots

to learn from the process while providing uninterrupted and powerful automation on a continuous basis without having to rely on humans at any level.

The key to deploying large-scale industry level automation is UiPath Orchestrator. This component is the server edition which manages and secures all-digital workflows, activates licenses, configurations and deploys from a few to thousands of robots. Users can thus assign automation work cues and schedule operations and actions as per convenience. Bringing in the capability to be deployed on premises as well as on cloud, on physical and virtual environments, you can enjoy the freedom to start small and scale quickly as per your requirements. Just one Orchestrator can easily deploy thousands of robots in real time. Powerful analytics and reporting tools such as Elasticsearch and Kibana deliver users with information on every aspect of the robot and user interaction and actions.

Increasing Operational Efficiency

Sharing an instance of successful implementation, Raghunath Subramanian cites one of UiPath's largest deployments that took place in Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corporation (SMBC), one of the biggest Japanese multinational banking and financial services companies. The aim of SMBC was to increase the efficiency and productivity of their operations. Implementation of RPA was identified as a key to the achievement of the aim. After much deliberation, SMBC zeroed in on UiPath as their choice of enterprise RPA platform. The result was phenomenal. The financial institution saved 650,000 hours across 250 front and back office operations. By the year 2019, the time saved is expected to rise up to a whopping 3 million hours.

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Domain Expertise and a Culture of Innovation

Enabling UiPath to exert such dominance in the RPA marketplace globally are some of the best minds equipped with unparallel domain expertise and a culture of innovation that is ingrained in the DNA of the company. Touching upon the support services, Raghunath Subramanian says, "Our technical support team is highly responsive and delivers 24x7 technical support. We also work along with the customers and partners throughout the cycle to ensure that the customers achieve their business goals. We support them at every step, assisting through proper reviews, best applications advice, best methodologies for implementation, RPA Center of Excellence (CoE) creation and more until the product goes into production in the right manner."

The UiPath Community Edition and the UiPath RPA Academy stand as a strong differentiator for the company. The free, fully functional and scalable software can be utilized in various commercial use cases to deliver great value. The UiPath Community Edition has already witnessed over 150,000 downloads with over 20,000 active community members. The UiPath RPA Academy is a much-required source of knowledge for all RPA enthusiasts looking at upskilling. It offers open self-paced courses at basic, intermediary, advanced and dedicated levels. As a part of a dedicated evangelism program, UiPath also reaches out to multiple universities around the globe familiarizing students with the technology.

Envisioning the future, UiPath has geared itself for the challenges ahead with a clear product growth map where AI and machine learning are the focus areas. The company is expanding its Engineering Division in India with efforts dedicated to taking the UiPath RPA Platform to the next level. UiPath is also working closely with its partners and enterprises, exploring newer areas where RPA can be implemented to mitigate operational bottlenecks. CR